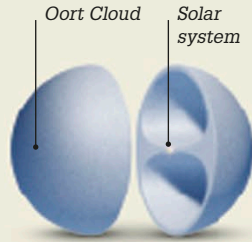


Beyond Neptune

The distant region of the solar system beyond Neptune is a cold, dark place containing an unknown number of dwarf planets, comets, asteroids, and smaller objects.

The Oort Cloud

At the edge of the solar system is a giant spherical cloud, known as the Oort Cloud. Named after the Dutch astronomer Jan Oort, it is thought to contain trillions of comets.



Earth for comparison



Dwarf planets

Dwarf planets are small planets found mainly in the Kuiper Belt—a region of the solar system beyond Neptune. The asteroid Ceres, found in the Asteroid Belt between Jupiter and Mars, is also counted as a dwarf planet. Listed above are some of the main dwarf planets.

8. Neptune

Diameter: 30,775 miles (49,528 km)
Distance from Sun: 30 AU
Year: 165 years
Day: 16 hours
Number of moons: 14
Cloud-top temperature: -330°F (-201°C)

7. Uranus

Diameter: 31,763 miles (51,118 km)
Distance from Sun: 19.2 AU
Year: 84 years
Day: 17 hours
Number of moons: 27
Cloud-top temperature: -323°F (-197°C)

6. Saturn

Diameter: 74,897 miles (120,536 km)
Distance from Sun: 9.6 AU
Year: 29.5 years
Day: 10.6 hours
Number of moons: 62
Cloud-top temperature: -292°F (-180°C)

Uranus

1.8 billion miles
(3 billion km)

Neptune

2.7 billion miles
(4.5 billion km)